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SUPERSEDING
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October 15, 1963
Interim Revision of
Fed.Spec. DDD-B-35
February 26, 1957

INTERIM FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

BANDAGE, ABSORBENT, ADHESIVE

This Interim Federal Specification was developed by the General Services Administration, Federal Supply Service, Washington, DC 20406, based upon currently available technical information. It is recommended that Federal agencies use it in procurement and forward recommendations for changes to the preparing activity at the address shown above.

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this Interim Federal Specification as a valid exception to Federal Specification DDD-B-35, dated February 26, 1957.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers complete, sterile packaged protective adhesive bandages for use on minor cuts, abrasions, and puncture wounds.

1.2 Classification.

1.2.1 Sizes. The bandages shall be of the following sizes, as specified (see 6.1).

3/8 by 1-1/2 inches
3/4 by 3 inches
1 by 3 inches
1-1/2 by 1-1/2 inches
2 by 4-1/2 inches
7/8 inch round

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

Federal Specifications:

L-C-166 - Cellulose, Absorbent, Surgical.
CCC-G-101 - Gauze, Absorbent.
JJJ-C-561 - Cotton, Sterile (Purified) and Nonsterile.
PPP-B-566 - Boxes, Folding, Paperboard.
PPP-B-636 - Box, Fiberboard.
PPP-B-665 - Boxes, Paperboard, Metal Stayed (Including Stay Material).
PPP-B-676 - Boxes, Setup.

Federal Standards:

Fed. Std. No. 123 - Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civil Agencies).
Fed. Test Method Std. No. 191 - Textile Test Methods.

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.

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(Single copies of this specification and other Federal Specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from Business Service Centers at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, DC, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, MO, Fort Worth, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, WA.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless a specific issue is identified, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

Technical Association of the Pulp and Paper Industry (TAPPI) Test Methods:

T 402 os-49 - Conditioning Paper and Paperboard for Testing.
T 403 ts-63 - Bursting Strength of Paper.
T 410 os-68 - Weight Per Unit Area (Basis Weight or Substance) of Paper and Paperboard.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Technical Association of the Pulp and Paper Industry, One Dunwoody Park, Atlanta, GA 30341.)

U.S. Pharmacopeia Convention, Inc.

Pharmacopeia of the United States (U.S.P.)

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Mack Printing Company, Easton, PA 18042.)

National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Inc., Agent:

National Motor Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Associations, Inc., Tariff Order Section, 1616 P Street, N.W., Washington, DC 20036.)

Uniform Classification Committee, Agent:

Uniform Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Room 202, Union Station, 516 W. Jackson Blvd., Chicago, IL 60606.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Materials.

3.1.1 Absorbent materials. The absorbent material used for the compress shall be one or a combination of the following, as specified in 3.2.2.

1. Cotton.
2. Rayon.
3. Gauze.
4. Absorbent cellulose.

3.1.1.1 Cotton. The cotton shall meet the requirements of grade B cotton as specified in DDD-C-561.

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3.1.1.2 Rayon. The rayon shall meet the requirements of grade A cotton as specified in DDD-C-561, except that water extract remainder may be one percent, and two percent ash residue is permitted on ignition.

3.1.1.3 Gauze. The gauze shall be type I or type III bleached gauze as specified in CCC-G-101.

3.1.1.3.1 Alternate gauze. As an alternate, a bleached absorbent gauze with 40 warp and 32 filling, ± 3 threads per inch shall be used (see 3.2.2.1).

3.1.1.4 Absorbent cellulose. The absorbent cellulose shall meet the requirement of L-C-166, except for paragraph 3.2 Form and Width, and paragraph 3.3 Weight.

3.1.2 Compress cover. Where a cover is used over the compress, it shall be a suitable organic film, which is smooth, non-toxic, and insoluable in the wound. The film shall not adhere to the wound. The film shall be perforated or partially slit to form valvules. The perforations or valvules shall be uniformly distributed over the compress, and shall be of such size and number, that wound exudates will be readily transmitted to and absorbed by the compress.

3.1.3 Adhesive plaster backing. The backing material shall be a flexible flesh-colored continuous, uniformly formed, organic film plasticized with a non-toxic compound, and shall have a minimum breaking strength of 3.5 pounds per inch width after perforating (see 3.2.1).

3.1.4 Adhesive mass. The adhesive mass shall have pressure sensitive adhesive properties, the base of which shall be new, natural or synthetic rubber or a single component acrylic adhesive. The weight of adhesive mass shall be not less than 1.7 ounces per square yard for new, natural or synthetic rubber base adhesive and shall be not less than 1.0 ounces per square yard for single component acrylic adhesive.

3.1.5 Facing material. The facing material shall be smooth, continuous, organic or metallic film, laminated with paper, or plain. The facing material shall be capable of being removed without contaminating the compress, or breaking or cracking, and shall be chemically inert to the adhesive mass.

3.1.6 Paper for envelopes. The paper for envelopes shall be either white sterilizable kraft or glassine.

3.1.6.1 White kraft. The white kraft shall be sterilizable. The basis weight shall be not less than 22 pounds per 500 sheets 24 by 36 inches. Tensile strength shall be not less than 12 pounds per inch in the machine direction, and not less than 7 pounds per inch in the cross direction. The porosity shall be not less than 65 seconds per 100 cc. of air passing through a 1 square inch center of area when determined by a Gurley densitometer.

3.1.6.2 Glassine. The glassine paper shall have a basis weight of not less than 23 pounds per 500 sheets, 24 by 36 inches. The bursting strength shall be not less than 15 points when tested in accordance with T 402 ts-63 of TAPPI Test Methods.

3.2 Construction.

3.2.1 Adhesive plaster. The adhesive plaster shall be made of an adhesive plaster backing as specified in 3.1.3, with a suitable adhesive mass as specified in 3.1.4, which is either sprayed, solvent spread, or calendered on one side. If the adhesive mass is solvent spread, the solvent used shall not remain within the plaster mass, nor shall the solvent used cause skin reactions when the adhesive plaster is applied. Except for the 3/8 by 1-1/2 inch size, the backing for the bandages shall be perforated where the compress is to be attached, with holes or slots to permit adequate ventilation. There shall be not less than 12 perforations per square inch, uniformly distributed over the entire compress area with the total area of the perforation to be not less than 2 percent nor more than 15 percent of the perforated area. The perforations may extend beyond the compress.

3.2.2 Compress. Each compress shall be cut and assembled so that there shall be no uncovered absorbent cellulose, cotton or rayon, or loose threads, and there shall be a minimum of raw edges. The pad shall be composed of materials which shall not disintegrate when standing in water for 24 hours, and shall conform to the requirements for the compress of U.S.P. adhesive bandages.

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3.2.2.1 Types. The compress for each size shall be of one of the following types:

(a) Four layers of type I gauze (see 3.1.1.3).
(b) Top layer of gauze (see 3.1.1.3.1) and filler of cotton, rayon or absorbent cellulose.
(c) Top layer of type I gauze and filler of cotton, rayon, or absorbent cellulose.
(d) Top layer of plastic film (see 3.1.2) with material or combination of materials listed in 3.1.1.
(e) Four under layers of absorbent gauze, U.S.P., type III, covered with one layer of absorbent gauze, U.S.P., type I. Shall be equivalent in absorbency to a compress of four layers of absorbent gauze, U.S.P., type I.

3.2.2.2 Weight and absorbent capacity. Except for the 2 by 4-1/2 inch size, the weight and absorbent capacity of types a, b, c, d, and e compresses shall be approximately equal to, but not less than, the weight and absorbent capacity of type a compresses of the same size. The weight and absorbent capacity of the compress used in the 2 by 4-1/2 inch size shall be not less than twice the weight and absorption capacity of a type a compress.

3.2.2.3 Size. The size of each compress shall be as specified in table I for each size, with the additional requirement that the compress shall not be wider than the adhesive plaster strip on rectangular bandages.

3.2.3 Assembly. The compress shall be firmly attached to the approximate center of the piece of adhesive plaster in such a manner that there will be a minimum of ravelings or loose threads from the compress. The compress shall not extend beyond the edges of the adhesive plaster. Two strips of the facing material shall be applied to the exposed portion of the adhesive plaster in such a manner as to fully cover and overlap the compress by at least 1/8 inch, to allow easy removal without contamination of the compress.

3.2.4 Dimensions. Dimensions of bandage and compress shall be as shown in table I. Corners or ends of the adhesive plaster for the rectangular bandages may be rounded, or all corners may be rectangular.

TABLE I

Nominal bandage size, inches	Minimum overall dimensions 1/		Minimum compress dimensions 1/	
	Width or Diameter inches	Length inches	Width or Diameter inches	Length inches
3/8 by 1-1/2	11/32	1-7/16	9/32	3/8
3/4 by 3	11/16	2-27/32	9/16	7/8
1 by 3	15/16	2-27/32	13/16	7/8
1-1/2 by 1-1/2	1-7/16	1-7/16	1/2	1/2
2 by 4-1/2 2/	1-15/16	4-1/4	1-9/16	1-5/8
	7/8 (Dia.) 13/16 (Dia.)	------	5/16 (Dia.)	-------

1/ Maximum dimensions are not listed. No bandage overall dimension shall exceed the nominal dimension by more than 25 percent.
2/ The adhesive plaster shall be tapered on both ends.

3.3 Adhesive quality. The adhesive quality of the plaster shall meet the test specified in 4.4.2.

3.4 Wrapping. Each completed bandage shall be enclosed in an individual paper envelope made from paper as specified in 3.1.6 and sealed. The individual paper envelope shall not be capable of being resealed after it is opened. Each envelope shall be marked so as to permit ready identification and shall bear the name or registered trademark of the manufacturer. The envelope shall be marked with a legend indicating sterility or guaranteeing sterility if the envelope has not been damaged or opened.

3.5 Sterilization and certification of sterility.

3.5.1 Sterilization. All bandages shall be sterilized after packaging in the individual envelopes. Sterilization shall be accomplished by high-pressure steam or other suitable means so as to render the bandage sterile in the individual package. The bandage shall be thoroughly dry after sterilization.

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3.5.2 Certificate of sterility. A certificate of sterility, stating that samples from each sterilizer charge have been tested and found to be sterile, shall be submitted to the procuring activity. The certifiate of sterility shall include:

(a) Item identification.
(b) Federal stock number.
(c) Contract or purchase order number.
(d) Sterilization lot or control number.
(e) Date of sterilization.
(f) Method of sterilization.
(g) Date sterility test was started.
(h) Specific U.S.P. test method used and results.
(i) Statement that samples comply with U.S.P. sterility test.
(j) Signature of head of laboratory or a designated alternate qualified in the testing performed.
(k) Quantity in sterilizer load.

When inspection is made at destination, the certificate of sterility shall be submitted by the contractor to the procuring activity and a copy forwarded with each shipment to consignee. When inspection is made at source, certificate of sterility shall be furnished to the cognizant Government quality assurance representative, for submission to the procuring activity. Complete records, which shall include the gauge pressure and temperature readings, shall be maintained by the contractor for a period not less than two years for the date of delivery of contract material to the Government and shall be made available upon request. The Government reserves the right to test such product material for sterility.

3.6 Workmanship. Workmanship shall be first class throughout. Bandages and envelopes shall be free from defects which detract from their appearance or which may impair their serviceability.

3.7 Delivery. Not more than six months shall have elapsed from the date of manufacture of the bandages to the date of delivery to the Government.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own facilities or any commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Manufacturers' protocol. A manufacturers' protocol that lists the end item testing and inspection characteristics with specification requirements and states that the test results and inspection results comply with said requirements is acceptable providing the test results are made readily available to the Government representative upon request.

4.2 Sampling.

4.2.1 Method of drawing samples.

4.2.1.1 Sampling for visual inspection. The sample size for visual inspection shall be determined according to the lot size in accordance with MIL-STD-105.

4.2.2 Sampling for dimensional inspection and tests. Unless otherwise specified, sampling shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105. Destructive testing shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105.

4.3 Inspection. Samples shall be inspected to determine compliance with specification requirements (see 6.1).

4.3.1 Location of inspection. Inspection of the finished bandages may be made either at point of production or at point of delivery, as specified (see 6.1). In case of factory inspection, every facility shall be afforded inspectors, by the manufacturer, for the prosecution of their work.

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4.4 Tests and examination.

4.4.1 Sterility test. The sterility test shall be performed as described under sterility tests for gauze, and cotton in the current revision of the U.S.P.

4.4.2 Adhesive quality. Ten adhesive bandages in their paper envelopes, shall be taken at random from each lot, and placed in an oxygen bomb. Oxygen pressure of 300 pounds per square inch shall be maintained for 40 hours at 71°C. At the end of the 40 hour period, the adhesive bandages shall be removed and kept at room temperature protected from light. After a minimum time of 12 hours, the envelopes shall be opened and the facing removed. The adhesive mass shall appear essentially unchanged. The adhesive bandages on which the adhesive mass strings out in long threads when the smooth, flat surface of the nail is applied to it and withdrawn; or when applied to the skin, and upon removal leaves quantities of adhesive mass on the skin, are considered rejectable.

4.4.3 Examination.

4.4.3.1 Classification of defects. The bandage shall be examined for visual and dimensional defects. Defects shall be classified as shown below:

Categories and defects

Major S-3 AQL 1.0 Unit of product-Bandage.

101 Backing not flesh colored.
102 Two strips of facing not overlapping the compress.
103 Compress not firmly attached.
104 Compress not free of excessive raveling.

Major B Level II AQL 2.5 Unit of product-Bandage with envelope.

151 Envelope not properly sealed.
152 Envelope not free of pinholes.
153 Envelope not correctly labeled.

Minor S-3 AQL 2.5 Unit of product-Bandage.

201 Facing material not smooth.
202 Backing (where pad is attached) not perforated (except 3/8 x 1-1/2).
203 Compress not approximate center of adhesive plaster.
204 Width of compress not equal (or not less than) width of plaster backing.
205 Overall dimension of bandage not within limits.
206 Overall dimension of compress not within limits.

Note: Examination is not restricted to the preceding listed possible defects. Where applicable, the same sample may be used for two or more tests.

4.4.3.2 Examination of preparation for delivery. An examination shall be made to determine whether the packaging, packing, and marking comply with the requirements of section 5. Defects shall be scored as specified in table II. Sampling shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105. The sample unit shall be one container fully prepared for delivery. The lot shall be the number of containers offered for inspection at one time. The inspection level shall be S-2 with an AQL of 4.0 expressed in terms of defects per hundred units.

TABLE II. Examination of preparation for delivery

Examination	Defect
Containers	Not as specified.
Contents	Not as specified.
Markings	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.
Materials	Component missing or damaged.
Workmanship	Bulging or distortion of containers.
	Cushioning inadequate, improper, or missing.

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4.4.3.3 Examination for closure sealing and reinforcement of containers. When shipping containers are required to comply with PPP-B-636, examination for defects in closure sealing and reinforcement shall be in accordance with the appendix of that specification.

4.4.4 Tests.

4.4.4.1 Tests shall be conducted in accordance with methods designated in Table III.

TABLE III. Test Methods

Test	Test reference Fed. Test Method No. 191	TAPPI	Test paragraph
Breaking strength (plaster backing)	Method 5102 1/		
Sterility of bandage			4.4.1
Adhesive quality of bandage			4.4.2
Weight of adhesive mass			4.4.4.2
Disintegration of compress			4.4.4.3
Basis weight of paper		T410 os-68	
Bursting strength of paper		T403 ts-63	
Porosity of paper	Method 5452		

1/ The specimen shall be the adhesive bandage full length, with the facing material peeled off.

Note: Referenced specifications and the U.S. Pharmacopeia shall be utilized for testing of components where applicable.

4.4.4.2 Weight of adhesive mass (rubber). The adhesive mass shall be determined on approximately 20 square inches of the adhesive plaster prior to attachment of the compress, or as an alternate adequate samples shall be prepared from the adhesive bandages by removal of the compress and attached backing. The weight of the sample shall be determined. The plaster mass shall be removed from the specimen by repeated immersion in Petroleum Ether, U.S.P. After removal of the ether soluble material, the backing shall be dried for 30 minutes at room temperature and the weight determined. The weight of the plaster mass shall be the original weight of the adhesive plaster minus the weight of the plaster backing. Three samples shall be tested and averaged.

4.4.4.2.1 Weight of adhesive mass (acrylic). For extracting the acrylic adhesive from the plastic film, use a blend of 30 cc. of n-heptane and 20 cc. of anhydrous isopropanol. Place the tape, without any facings, in the solvent blend and agitate for 35-45 minutes to remove the acrylic adhesive from the plastic film. Remove film from the solvent blend and air dry for one hour and reweigh.

4.4.4.3 Disintegration of compress. Five pad compresses shall be placed in distilled water at room temperature (70 - 90°F.) for 24 hours (see 3.2.2) and examined for evidence of breaking up into parts and fragments.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A, B, or C, as specified (see 6.1).

5.1.1 Level A or B. Bandages covered by this specification shall be packaged in accordance with PPP-B-566 and in quantities and within unit cartons as specified in table IV.

TABLE IV

Nominal size inches	Number of bandages per unit	Number of units per intermediate package	Number of units per exterior container
3/8 by 1-1/2	100	36	144
3/4 by 3	100	36	144
3/4 by 3	18 1/	48	576
1 by 3	100	36	144
1 by 3	16 1/	48	576
1-1/2 by 1-1/2	100	36	144
2 by 4-1/2	50	18	72
7/8 (diameter)	100	36	144

1/ Special package for "Unit" type first aid kits.

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5.1.1.1 Intermediate package. Bandages packaged as specified in 5.1.1 shall be intermediately packaged in quantities as specified in table IV in paperboard folding or set-up boxes conforming to PPP-B-[illegible], PPP-B-[illegible], or PPP-B-636, respectively. Boxes shall be secured to prevent accidental opening.

5.1.2 Level C. Bandages shall be packaged to afford adequate protection against damage during shipment from the supply source to the first receiving agency.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or C, as specified (see 6.1).

5.2.1 Level A. Bandages packaged as specified in 5.1.1 in quantities specified in table IV shall be packed in a box conforming to PPP-B-636, class weather resistant.

5.2.2 Level B. Bandages packaged as specified in 5.1.1 in quantities specified in table IV shall be packed in a box conforming to PPP-B-636, class domestic.

5.2.3 Level C. Bandages in quantities as specified (see 6.1) packaged as specified in 5.1 shall be packed in containers to assure carrier acceptance and safe arrival at destination in compliance with Uniform Freight Classification or National Motor Freight Classification, as applicable.

5.3 Marking. In addition to any special marking required in the procurement document, marking of the interior packages and exterior shipping containers shall be in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123 for civil agencies and MIL-STD-129 for military agencies, as applicable (see 6.1).

6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein and include the following information in procurement documents:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Size required (see 1.2.1).
(c) Sampling required (see 4.2).
(d) Inspection required (see 4.3).
(e) Location of inspection (see 4.3.1).
(f) Selection of applicable levels of packaging and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).
(g) Marking document required (see 5.3).
(h) Quantities required (see 5.2.3).

6.2 This specification does not include all types, classes, grades, sizes, etc., of the commodity indicated by the title of the specification, or which are commercially available, but is intended to cover the types, etc., which are normally procured to meet Federal Government requirements.

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Army-MI
Navy-MD
Air Force

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